

# Word family: **ruin / ruins / ruined / ruining / ruinous / ruination**

**Base word:** ruin

**Part of speech:** mainly **verb** and **noun**

**Related forms:**

\* **ruin** (v.) — 毀掉；破壞；使破產；使身敗名裂

\* **ruin** (n.) — 毀滅；破敗；破產；衰敗

\* **ruins** (plural n.) — 廢墟；遺跡

\* **ruined** (adj./participle) — 被毀掉的；破敗的；破產的

\* **ruinous** (adj.) — 毀滅性的；造成重大損失的；昂貴得難以承受的

\* **ruination** (n.) — 毀滅；破產；敗壞 (較正式、較少用)

**Useful expressions / extensions:**

\* **ruin a team**

\* **ruin a relationship**

\* **ruin someone's reputation**

\* **ruin someone's chances**

\* **ruin a career**

\* **ruin a business**

\* **ruin a meal / day / holiday**

\* **be financially ruined**

\* **be ruined by**

\* **the ruin of**

\* **financial ruin**

\* **economic ruin**

\* **bring someone to ruin**

\* **go to ruin**

\* **fall into ruin**

\* **lie in ruins**

\* **in ruins**

\* **ancient ruins**

\* **a ruined building**

\* **ruinous costs**

\* **ruinous consequences**

\* **be the ruin of someone**

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## Meaning in this passage

> A second difficulty is poor communication, which can quietly **ruin** even a talented team.

Here, **ruin** means:

#### \*\*to damage something so severely that it no longer works successfully or retains its value — 毀掉；徹底破壞\*\*

Poor communication may gradually destroy the effectiveness, trust, coordination, and success of an otherwise talented team.

\*\*中文翻譯：\*\*

第二個困難是溝通不良，它可以在不知不覺間\*\*毀掉 / 徹底破壞\*\*一支即使很有才能的團隊。

So here:

#### \*\*ruin a team = 把團隊的合作、信任和效能破壞到嚴重失效的程度\*\*

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# 1. \*\*ruin something — 毀掉；嚴重破壞\*\*

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

#### Practice 1 — original sentence

> Poor communication can quietly \*\*ruin even a talented team\*\*.

溝通不良可以在不知不覺間\*\*毀掉一支即使很有才能的團隊\*\*。

#### Practice 2

> One serious conflict can \*\*ruin months of teamwork\*\*.

一次嚴重衝突就可能\*\*毀掉數月的團隊合作成果\*\*。

#### Practice 3

> Lack of trust can \*\*ruin a strong working relationship\*\*.

缺乏信任可以\*\*破壞一段原本良好的工作關係\*\*。

\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\*

\*\*ruin = 嚴重破壞某物，使它失去原有價值、效能或成功的可能\*\*

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# 2. \*\*ruin a relationship — 毀掉一段關係\*\*

#### ### Practice 1

> Constant dishonesty can \*\*ruin a relationship\*\*.

不斷說謊可以\*\*毀掉一段關係\*\*。

#### ### Practice 2

> Their friendship was nearly \*\*ruined by jealousy\*\*.

他們的友誼差點被嫉妒\*\*破壞殆盡\*\*。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*ruin a relationship = 把人與人之間的信任和關係破壞到很嚴重的程度\*\***

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# 3. **\*\*ruin someone's reputation — 毀掉某人的名聲\*\***

#### ### Practice 1

> A false accusation can \*\*ruin someone's reputation\*\*.

一項虛假指控可能\*\*毀掉某人的名聲\*\*。

#### ### Practice 2

> The scandal nearly \*\*ruined his reputation\*\*.

醜聞差點\*\*毀掉他的聲譽\*\*。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*ruin someone's reputation = 嚴重破壞別人對某人的看法和信任\*\***

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# 4. **\*\*ruin someone's career — 毀掉某人的事業\*\***

#### ### Practice 1

> One dishonest act could \*\*ruin his career\*\*.

一次不誠實的行為可能\*\*毀掉他的事業\*\*。

#### ### Practice 2

> The controversy almost **ruined her career**.

這場爭議差點**斷送她的事業**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**ruin someone's career** = 令某人的職業發展受到極嚴重甚至長期的破壞

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# 5. **ruin someone's chances** — 破壞某人的機會；使希望落空

Practice 1

> Missing the deadline may **ruin our chances of winning the contract**.

錯過截止日期可能會**令我們失去取得合約的機會**。

Practice 2

> His poor interview **ruined his chances of getting the job**.

他面試表現欠佳，**毀掉了獲聘的機會**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**ruin someone's chances** = 令某人原本可能成功的機會大幅下降或完全消失

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# 6. **ruin a plan / project** — 毀掉計劃 / 項目

Practice 1

> Poor planning can **ruin an otherwise promising project**.

規劃不善可以**毀掉一個原本很有前景的項目**。

Practice 2

> The unexpected delay **ruined our original plan**.

突如其來的延誤**破壞了我們原本的計劃**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**ruin a plan/project** = 嚴重破壞計劃，使其不能按原意成功進行

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# 7. \*\*ruin a day / evening / holiday — 毀掉一天 / 晚上 / 假期\*\*

A very common everyday use.

#### ### Practice 1

> The argument \*\*ruined the evening\*\*.

那場爭吵\*\*毀掉了整個晚上\*\*。

#### ### Practice 2

> Heavy rain \*\*ruined our holiday\*\*.

大雨\*\*毀了我們的假期\*\*。

\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\*

\*\*ruin an occasion = 令原本應該愉快或成功的活動變得很差\*\*

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# 8. \*\*ruin a meal / food — 把食物弄壞\*\*

#### ### Practice 1

> Too much salt \*\*ruined the soup\*\*.

太多鹽\*\*把湯弄壞了\*\*。

#### ### Practice 2

> Don't overcook the fish or you'll \*\*ruin it\*\*.

不要把魚煮過頭，否則會\*\*把它煮壞\*\*。

\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\*

\*\*ruin food = 因烹調或處理不當令食物質素嚴重變差\*\*

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# 9. \*\*ruin clothes / objects — 把衣物 / 物品弄壞\*\*

#### ### Practice 1

> The bleach \*\*ruined my shirt\*\*.

漂白劑\*\*把我的恤衫弄壞了\*\*。

#### ### Practice 2

> Water can \*\*ruin electronic equipment\*\*.

水可以\*\*嚴重損壞電子設備\*\*。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*ruin an object = 把物件損壞到不能正常使用或失去原有價值\*\***

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# 10. **\*\*be ruined by something — 被.....毀掉\*\***

#### ### Practice 1

> The presentation was \*\*ruined by technical problems\*\*.

簡報被技術問題\*\*弄砸了\*\*。

#### ### Practice 2

> The relationship was \*\*ruined by a lack of trust\*\*.

這段關係因缺乏信任而被\*\*破壞\*\*。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*be ruined by X = 因 X 而受到極嚴重破壞\*\***

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# 11. **\*\*ruined ( adj. : 被毀壞的 ; 破敗的 ) — 被毀壞的 ; 破敗的\*\***

#### ### Practice 1

> They walked past a \*\*ruined building\*\*.

他們走過一棟\*\*破敗的建築物\*\*。

#### ### Practice 2

> The fire left several houses \*\*ruined\*\*.

大火令數間房屋\*\*嚴重毀壞\*\*。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*ruined = 已被嚴重破壞，不能保持原本完整或正常狀態的\*\***

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# 12. **\*\*ruin someone financially — 使某人破產；使財務崩潰\*\***

A major distinct branch.

### Practice 1

> The failed investment nearly **\*\*ruined him financially\*\***.

這項失敗的投資差點令他**\*\*破產\*\***。

### Practice 2

> Huge legal costs could **\*\*ruin a small business owner\*\***.

巨額法律費用可能令小企業東主**\*\*陷入財務崩潰\*\***。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*ruin someone financially = 令某人損失大量金錢，以至財務狀況崩潰\*\***

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# 13. **\*\*ruin a business / company — 令企業倒閉 / 陷入崩潰\*\***

### Practice 1

> Years of poor management **\*\*ruined the business\*\***.

多年管理不善**\*\*毀掉了這盤生意\*\***。

### Practice 2

> One disastrous contract nearly **\*\*ruined the company\*\***.

一份災難性的合約差點令公司**\*\*倒閉\*\***。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*ruin a business = 令企業遭受嚴重損失，甚至不能繼續營運\*\***

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# 14. \*\*financial ruin — 財務崩潰；破產\*\*

### Practice 1

> The family faced \*\*financial ruin\*\*.

這個家庭面臨\*\*財務崩潰\*\*。

### Practice 2

> Heavy debts brought the company close to \*\*financial ruin\*\*.

巨額債務令公司接近\*\*破產\*\*。

\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\*

\*\*financial ruin = 財務狀況嚴重崩潰，失去大部分資產或償還能力\*\*

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# 15. \*\*bring someone to ruin — 使某人走向毀滅 / 破產\*\*

### Practice 1

> Reckless borrowing \*\*brought him to ruin\*\*.

魯莽借貸令他\*\*走向破產\*\*。

### Practice 2

> Years of corruption eventually \*\*brought the organisation to ruin\*\*.

多年的貪腐最終令該組織\*\*走向崩潰\*\*。

\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\*

\*\*bring X to ruin = 令某人或某機構最終遭受徹底失敗或破產\*\*

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# 16. \*\*ruin ( noun : 毀滅；崩潰 ) — 毀滅；敗亡\*\*

### Practice 1

> Poor leadership led to the company's \*\*ruin\*\*.

管理不善導致公司\*\*敗亡 / 崩潰\*\*。

### ### Practice 2

> Greed eventually brought about his **\*\*ruin\*\***.

貪婪最終導致他的**\*\*毀滅\*\***。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*ruin = 某人、機構或事物徹底失敗、被破壞或衰敗的狀態\*\***

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# 17. **\*\*the ruin of something — 某事物的毀滅 / 衰敗\*\***

### ### Practice 1

> Mismanagement was the **\*\*ruin of the company\*\***.

管理不善是公司**\*\*敗亡的原因\*\***。

### ### Practice 2

> Years of neglect led to the **\*\*ruin of the building\*\***.

多年缺乏保養令建築物逐漸**\*\*破敗\*\***。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*the ruin of X = X 被徹底破壞或走向衰敗\*\***

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# 18. **\*\*be the ruin of someone — 把某人害慘；成為某人的毀滅原因\*\***

A common dramatic idiom.

### ### Practice 1

> His gambling habits were nearly **\*\*the ruin of him\*\***.

他的賭博習慣差點**\*\*把他害慘 / 令他身敗名裂\*\***。

### ### Practice 2

> This constant overspending will **\*\*be the ruin of you\*\***.

你再這樣不斷超支，遲早會**\*\*把自己害慘\*\***。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*be the ruin of someone = 成為令某人遭受嚴重失敗、破產或痛苦的原因\*\***

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# 19. **\*\*go to ruin — 逐漸破敗；走向衰敗\*\***

### Practice 1

> The old house was allowed to **\*\*go to ruin\*\***.

那間舊屋任由它**\*\*逐漸破敗\*\***。

### Practice 2

> Without maintenance, the property will **\*\*go to ruin\*\***.

如果沒有保養，這個物業會逐漸**\*\*荒廢破敗\*\***。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*go to ruin = 因缺乏保養、管理或照顧而逐漸嚴重衰敗\*\***

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# 20. **\*\*fall into ruin — 陷入破敗；荒廢\*\***

### Practice 1

> The castle **\*\*fell into ruin\*\*** after it was abandoned.

城堡被棄置後逐漸**\*\*荒廢破敗\*\***。

### Practice 2

> Several historic buildings have **\*\*fallen into ruin\*\***.

數座歷史建築已經**\*\*陷入破敗狀態\*\***。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*fall into ruin = 建築物或地方逐漸變得破敗、荒廢\*\***

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# 21. **\*\*in ruins — 成為廢墟；嚴重破敗\*\***

### Practice 1

> The building was left **\*\*in ruins\*\*** after the fire.

大火後，建築物只剩下**\*\*一片廢墟\*\***。

#### ### Practice 2

> Much of the old town lay **\*\*in ruins\*\***.

舊城大部分地區成為**\*\*廢墟\*\***。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*in ruins = 建築物等遭到嚴重破壞，只剩殘破部分\*\***

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# 22. **\*\*ruins ( 廢墟；遺跡 ) — 廢墟；古蹟遺址\*\***

A major countable plural noun sense.

#### ### Practice 1

> We visited the **\*\*ruins of an ancient temple\*\***.

我們參觀了一座古廟的**\*\*遺跡\*\***。

#### ### Practice 2

> The city is famous for its Roman **\*\*ruins\*\***.

這座城市以羅馬時代的**\*\*遺跡\*\***聞名。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*ruins = 建築物被破壞或年代久遠後留下的殘存部分\*\***

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# 23. **\*\*ancient / historic ruins — 古代 / 歷史遺跡\*\***

#### ### Practice 1

> Archaeologists explored the **\*\*ancient ruins\*\***.

考古學家探索那些**\*\*古代遺跡\*\***。

#### ### Practice 2

> Tourists come to see the **historic ruins**.

遊客前來參觀這些**歷史遺跡**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**ancient/historic ruins = 古代建築或城市留下的殘存部分**

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# 24. **ruined building / castle — 破敗建築 / 古堡**

### Practice 1

> A **ruined castle** stands on the hill.

山上矗立着一座**破敗的古堡**。

### Practice 2

> They restored a **ruined farmhouse**.

他們修復了一間**破敗農舍**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**ruined building = 已受到嚴重破壞或長期荒廢的建築物**

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# 25. **ruinous ( 毀滅性的 ) — 造成嚴重破壞的**

### Practice 1

> The policy had **ruinous consequences** for the small business.

這項政策對小企業造成了**毀滅性的後果**。

### Practice 2

> The conflict proved **ruinous** for the local economy.

這場衝突對本地經濟造成了**極具破壞性的影響**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**ruinous = 足以造成非常嚴重損失、破壞或崩潰的**

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# 26. **ruinous costs / expense** — 高昂得難以承受的費用

### Practice 1

> The legal dispute involved **ruinous costs**.

這場法律糾紛帶來**高昂得難以承受的費用**。

### Practice 2

> Repairs would have been **ruinously expensive**.

維修費會**昂貴得幾乎令人破產**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**ruinous costs** = 高昂到足以造成嚴重財務損害的費用

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# 27. **ruination** — 毀滅；敗壞；破產

A formal and less common noun.

### Practice 1

> Years of reckless spending led to his **financial ruination**.

多年的魯莽消費導致他的**財務崩潰**。

### Practice 2

> The war caused the **ruination** of many towns.

戰爭造成許多城鎮的**毀滅**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**ruination** = formal: 徹底破壞、衰敗或財務崩潰的過程或結果

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# Important distinction 1: **ruin vs damage**

This is the biggest distinction.

### \*\*damage\*\*

harm something, but it may still function or recover.

### \*\*ruin\*\*

damage it so badly that its value, success, usefulness, or enjoyment is largely destroyed.

> The argument damaged the relationship.

> 爭吵\*\*損害了\*\*關係。

> The argument ruined the relationship.

> 爭吵\*\*毀掉了\*\*關係。

**Ruin is much stronger.**

---

# Important distinction 2: **ruin vs destroy**

### \*\*destroy\*\*

physically or completely eliminate something.

### \*\*ruin\*\*

make it useless, unsuccessful, spoiled, or severely damaged; it may still physically exist.

> Fire destroyed the house.

> 大火把房屋燒毀。

> Years of neglect ruined the house.

> 多年的荒廢令房屋嚴重破敗。

So **destroy** often stresses physical elimination; **ruin** stresses loss of function/value/success.

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# Important distinction 3: **ruin vs spoil**

### \*\*spoil\*\*

make something less enjoyable, attractive, or good.

### \*\*ruin\*\*

stronger: make it very bad or effectively useless.

> The noise spoiled the evening.

> 噪音令晚上沒有那麼愉快。

> The argument ruined the evening.

> 爭吵\*\*徹底毀掉了整個晚上\*\*。

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# Important distinction 4: \*\*ruin vs wreck\*\*

### \*\*wreck\*\*

severely damage physically, or figuratively damage plans/lives.

### \*\*ruin\*\*

broader and more neutral in register.

> wreck a car

> 把車撞毀

> ruin a career

> 毀掉事業

Both can be figurative, but \*\*wreck\*\* often sounds more dramatic.

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# Important distinction 5: \*\*ruin vs undermine\*\*

### \*\*undermine\*\*

gradually weaken something.

### \*\*ruin\*\*

damage it to the point of serious failure.

This is especially relevant to your passage:

> poor communication may first \*\*undermine\*\* trust

> and eventually \*\*ruin\*\* the team.

So:

### \*\*undermine = 削弱\*\*

### \*\*ruin = 毀掉\*\*

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# Important distinction 6: \*\*ruin vs harm\*\*

### \*\*harm\*\*

broad: cause negative effects.

### \*\*ruin\*\*

far stronger.

> Stress harms performance.

> 壓力損害表現。

> A major scandal can ruin a career.

> 重大醜聞可以\*\*斷送事業\*\*。

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# Important distinction 7: \*\*ruin someone's chances vs reduce someone's chances\*\*

### \*\*reduce someone's chances\*\*

make success less likely.

### \*\*ruin someone's chances\*\*

make success extremely unlikely or impossible.

**Ruin** is much stronger.

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# Important distinction 8: \*\*ruin financially vs lose money\*\*

### \*\*lose money\*\*

suffer some financial loss.

### \*\*be financially ruined\*\*

suffer such severe loss that one's financial position collapses.

Not every financial loss equals ruin.

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# Important distinction 9: **\*\*ruin noun singular vs ruins plural\*\***

Very important.

### **\*\*ruin\*\*** singular/uncountable:

> financial ruin

> 財務崩潰

> the ruin of the company

> 公司的覆亡

### **\*\*ruins\*\*** plural:

> ancient ruins

> 古代遺跡

Do not translate both the same way.

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# Important distinction 10: **\*\*in ruins vs in decline\*\***

### **\*\*in decline\*\***

gradually becoming weaker.

### **\*\*in ruins\*\***

already severely destroyed or broken down.

> The industry is in decline.

> 行業正在衰退。

> The building is in ruins.

> 建築物已成廢墟。

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# Important distinction 11: **\*\*go to ruin vs fall into ruin\*\***

Both describe progressive physical decay.

### **\*\*go to ruin\*\***

very common general expression.

### **\*\*fall into ruin\*\***

slightly more literary/formal.

Both can mean:

### **\*\*逐漸荒廢破敗\*\***

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# Important distinction 12: **\*\*ruinous vs ruined\*\***

### **\*\*ruinous\*\***

causes ruin.

> ruinous costs

> 足以令人破產的高昂費用

### **\*\*ruined\*\***

has suffered ruin.

> ruined business

> 已被搞垮的企業

Direction matters:

### **\*\*ruinous = causes destruction\*\***

### **\*\*ruined = receives destruction\*\***

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# Important distinction 13: **\*\*ruinous vs disastrous\*\***

### **\*\*disastrous\*\***

having extremely bad results.

### \*\*ruinous\*\*

especially emphasizes destruction or severe financial/material loss.

> disastrous decision

> 災難性的決定

> ruinous legal costs

> 足以令人破產的法律費用

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# Important distinction 14: \*\*ruin a team does not necessarily mean the team disappears\*\*

In your passage:

> poor communication can \*\*ruin a talented team\*\*

does not necessarily mean:

\* everyone resigns,

\* the team formally stops existing.

It means:

### the team may still exist, but its trust, coordination, productivity, and ability to succeed are badly damaged.

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# Important distinction 15: \*\*quietly ruin\*\*

The adverb \*\*quietly\*\* matters.

The writer is not describing one dramatic disaster.

Instead:

### misunderstanding → duplicated work → missed details → delays → frustration → loss of trust

can gradually \*\*ruin\*\* the team without one obvious moment of collapse.

That makes \*\*quietly ruin\*\* especially effective.

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## # Family-extension note

The **ruin** family has several major modern branches:

### ### 1. **severely damage success/value**

- \* ruin a team
- \* ruin a relationship
- \* ruin a career

### ### 2. **spoil experiences or objects**

- \* ruin a holiday
- \* ruin a meal
- \* ruin clothes

### ### 3. **financial destruction**

- \* ruin a business
- \* financial ruin

### ### 4. **downfall / destruction as a noun**

- \* the ruin of a company
- \* bring someone to ruin

### ### 5. **physical decay**

- \* go to ruin
- \* fall into ruin
- \* in ruins

### ### 6. **historic remains**

- \* ancient ruins
- \* Roman ruins

### ### 7. **adjective family**

- \* ruined
- \* ruinous

For your passage, the exact branch is:

### \*\*ruin = damage a team's effectiveness and relationships so seriously that it can no longer work successfully\*\*

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#### # Master comparison

| Form / expression            | Traditional Chinese | Core idea                |
|------------------------------|---------------------|--------------------------|
| -----                        | -----               | -----                    |
| **ruin something**           | 毀掉；嚴重破壞             | destroy value/success    |
| **ruin a team**              | 毀掉團隊                | organizational failure   |
| **ruin a relationship**      | 毀掉關係                | trust destroyed          |
| **ruin a reputation**        | 毀掉名聲                | social standing          |
| **ruin a career**            | 斷送事業                | professional damage      |
| **ruin someone's chances**   | 毀掉機會                | success becomes unlikely |
| **ruin a plan**              | 破壞計劃                | plan fails               |
| **ruin a day/holiday**       | 毀掉一天 / 假期           | spoil experience         |
| **ruin food**                | 把食物弄壞               | quality destroyed        |
| **be ruined by**             | 被.....毀掉            | passive damage           |
| **ruin someone financially** | 令某人破產               | financial collapse       |
| **ruin a business**          | 搞垮企業                | business collapse        |
| **financial ruin**           | 財務崩潰                | insolvency-like state    |
| **bring X to ruin**          | 令 X 走向毀滅            | downfall                 |
| **ruin** (noun)              | 毀滅；衰敗               | destruction              |
| **the ruin of X**            | X 的敗亡 / 毀滅          | downfall                 |
| **be the ruin of someone**   | 把某人害慘               | cause downfall           |
| **go to ruin**               | 逐漸破敗                | decay                    |
| **fall into ruin**           | 陷入破敗                | decay                    |
| **in ruins**                 | 成為廢墟                | destroyed state          |
| **ruins**                    | 廢墟；遺跡               | remains                  |
| **ancient ruins**            | 古代遺跡                | archaeology              |
| **ruined building**          | 破敗建築                | destroyed structure      |
| **ruinous**                  | 毀滅性的                | causes ruin              |
| **ruinous costs**            | 昂貴得難以承受             | severe financial harm    |
| **ruination**                | 毀滅；敗壞               | formal noun              |

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#### ### For your original sentence

> A second difficulty is poor communication, which can quietly \*\*ruin even a talented team\*\*.

Here:

### \*\*ruin = 溝通不良逐步破壞團隊的協調、信任、效率和合作能力，嚴重到即使成員本身很有才能，團隊也無法有效發揮\*\*

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 第二個困難是溝通不良，它可以在不知不覺間\*\*毀掉一支即使很有才能的團隊\*\*。

The cleanest contrast is:

> \*\*harm\*\* = 造成負面影響

> \*\*damage\*\* = 損害

> \*\*undermine\*\* = 逐漸削弱

> \*\*spoil\*\* = 弄差、破壞享受

> \*\*ruin\*\* = \*\*嚴重破壞到原本的價值、效能或成功幾乎被毀掉\*\*

> \*\*destroy\*\* = 徹底毀滅，尤其常指實體或完全消失

For this passage, \*\*ruin\*\* is deliberately strong: the writer is saying that \*\*talent alone cannot save a team whose communication has broken down badly enough\*\*.